DIRECTING

46 Storyboard Examples from Movies, Animation, and Games (with FREE Storyboard Templates)

BY SC LANNOM ON JANUARY 1, 2026

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A storyboard is a graphic layout that sequences illustrations and images to tell a story visually. It is the backbone of visual storytelling, helping filmmakers, marketers, and educators communicate their ideas clearly and effectively.

Whether you're sketching storyboard ideas for a blockbuster movie or a business presentation, these storyboard examples will inspire you to elevate your concepts.

Professional directors rely on storyboards to:

- Visualize their ideas.
- Align their teams and avoid costly miscommunications.

For those seeking inspiration for storyboard examples will provide practical guidance and spark your creativity.

Take a look at these fantastic professional storyboard examples. Released by the DGA, they include storyboards from iconic films like:

- *Harry Potter*
- *Star Wars*
- *Inception*
- *Gladiator*
- *Jurassic Park*
- *Moulin Rouge*

Let these examples guide you in bringing your ideas to life, no matter your project!

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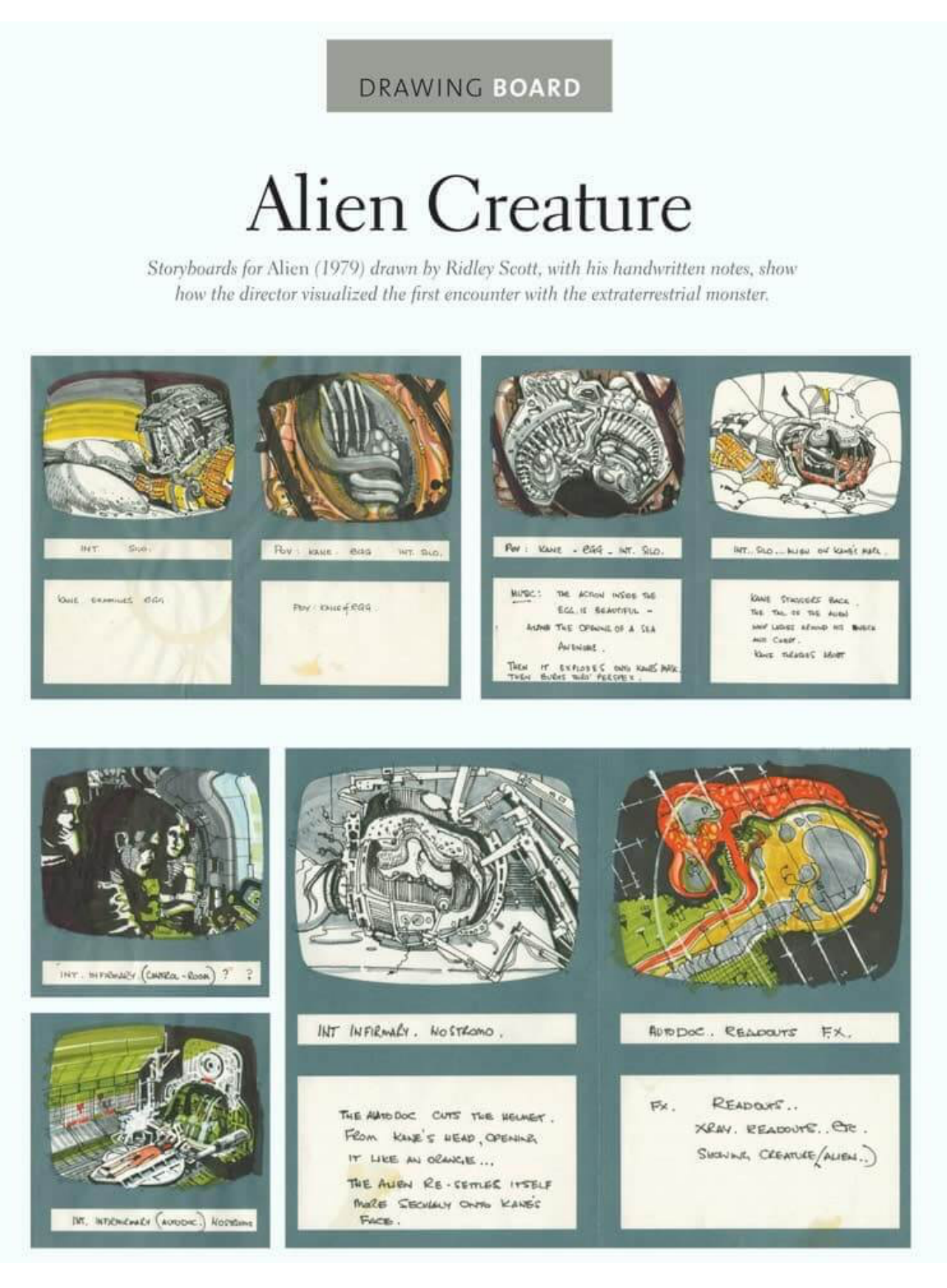
STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: HOW BLOCKBUSTERS ARE PLANNED

1. *Alien*

Scene: Infirmary Scene

One of the great examples of storyboard use comes from *Alien* (1979). Ridley Scott did not draw stick figures here, and while he probably picked up some pretty slick storyboarding skills when he attended the Royal College of Art, it doesn't mean you should throw in the towel or that you can't achieve similar results.

This *Alien* storyboard is a great source of inspiration for storyboard techniques, particularly for creating tension and atmosphere.


DRAWING BOARD
Alien Creature
Storyboards for Alien (1979) drawn by Ridley Scott, with his handwritten notes, show how the director visualized the first encounter with the extraterrestrial monster.
INT INFIRMARY. NOSTROMO.
AUTODOC. READOUTS FX.

Example of storyboard • Alien by Ridley Scott

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CRAFTING ICONIC SHOTS FOR THE GENRE

2. *Pacific Rim*

There are not many wide shots in these storyboards. Going from the control room to the outside takes careful film planning. There is a distinct Japanese/Anime vibe.

The use of negative space in this storyboard is similar to how light is used. The entire storyboard, including shot specs, can be viewed below.

Check out these Pacific Rim storyboards

Whether you're crafting a feature fi[illegible]ation, or marketing video, a well-planned storyboard is the key to seamless storytelling. This Pacific Rim sequence is a perfect video storyboard example, showing how negative space and shot transitions create tension and cinematic scale.

STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CRAFTING HIGH-STAKES SCENES

3. *Jurassic Park*

Scene: Raptor Attack Scene

The storyboarding notes help lead you into each new shot. Multiple slides (or cells) can be used for a single shot, especially if you plan to linger. Notations like 'foot toward the camera' demonstrate how to guide the viewer's eye. Directional arrows and detailed shot descriptions ensure a smoother transition between scenes, whether you're storyboarding a chase sequence or a product demo.

Example of storyboard • Jurassic Park

In *Jurassic Park*, the raptor attack storyboard is a masterclass in visual sequencing. It uses multiple slides to capture a single shot, with notes like "foot toward the camera" helping guide the viewer's eye. It's one of the most vivid examples of storyboard use that conveys both motion and suspense with clarity.

STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: WORLD-BUILDING ON PAPER

4. *Star Wars: A New Hope*

Scene: A Galaxy Far, Far Away

George Lucas made a storyboard for the title sequence. C3PO looks different in these. Tougher. Lucas knew how he wanted that final shot.

This *Star Wars* storyboard example shows how title sequences and character framing establish mood. Storyboarding examples like this are not just for epic space sagas—they're essential for visualizing scenes in any genre, from intimate dramas to high-octane action.

Film storyboard template • Star Wars: A New Hope

STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CRAFTING HIGH-STAKES SCENES

5. *Transformers*

Scene: Blackout's Rampage

I quickly notice thoughtful sketches of the production design. See how the artists visualize destruction? The blocking of the confused soldiers is particularly interesting, making this both a compelling composition and a beautifully crafted storyboard example.

Select Dynamic field

Example of storyboard • Transformers

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: THE FRAMES BEHIND LEGENDARY FILMS

6. *Inception*

Scene: Hallway Fight Scene

Curious how to storyboard a rotating room? The ceiling fan helps you stay oriented. See how the room is drawn the same across multiple slides? Techniques like these are often used in dynamic scenes—learn more in: How to Storyboard a Fight Scene.

Planning camera movements, such as the rotation in the hallway fight, is crucial for creating visually compelling action sequences.

Story board example • Inception

Note: The scene numbers were added by the storyboard artists.

The storyboard for the hallway fight scene in Inception shows how to map out rotating rooms and camera movements. The ceiling fan appears across several frames to anchor the audience's orientation. It's one of the top examples of storyboard use that can control spatial logic in visually disorienting sequences

MOVIE STORY BOARD EXAMPLES: ACTION PACKED SCENES

7. *Edge of Tomorrow*

Scene: Cage Drops In Scene

This storyboard shows a scene where Cage drops from the ship into battle. While many films strive to make every moment feel heroic, this one excels at capturing the chaotic unpredictability of battle.

Storyboard Examples - Edge of tomorrow Storyboard - StudioBinder

Edge of Tomorrow • Storyboard Example

We get camera movement and an indication that this shot was meant to be continued across multiple storyboard slides. Planning transitions like these are essential for visual flow—learn more in How to Storyboard Camera Movement.

RELATED POSTS
- Learn More: How to Make a Storyboard →
- Explore: The Best Storyboard Software to Try →
- Dive Deeper: Storyboard Ideas, Examples, and Techniques →

STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: THE FRAMES BEHIND LEGENDARY FILMS

8. *There Will Be Blood*

Scene: Oil Derrick Scene

Film directors put significant thought into the background imagery, which translates powerfully on screen. The scene features plenty of well-executed shot-to-reverse-shot sequences.

Click to view the full storyboard below:

Storyboards by P.K. MacCarthy • Click here to view There Will Be Blood's storyboard

STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: SAM MENDES MOVIE STORYBOARDS

9. *American Beauty*

Scene: Lester Bathroom Scene

The great thing about these storyboards from Sam Mendes' American Beauty is that they describe more than just the shots, they establish the scene.

The "CUT TO:'s" give us a sense of how the scene will be edited, while mentioning the steam coming out of the bathroom evokes the atmosphere. Storyboards can be primarily a tool for a director to map out the shots but this example shows us how they can also benefit collaborators like editor and cinematographers.

Storyboards by Robin Richesson • American Beauty stotryboard scene

Action-packed storyboard examples

STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: BRINGING THE PAST TO LIFE VISUALLY

10. *Gladiator*

Scene: Battle Tigers

Is there a clear chain of events in these storyboards? Intelligent camera placement leads to depth and layers.

Click to view the full storyboard below:

Click to view the Gladiator storyboard

Storyboarding these scenes beforeh[illegible]uch cheaper than practicing with real-life tigers. Less fun though.

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: MISDIRECTION AND SUSPENSE

11. *Tomorrow Never Dies*

Scene: Banner Escape

You should always storyboard stunts for extra safety. It will help your stunt coordinators too. Costume designers decided to change both costumes.

Example of storyboard • Tomorrow Never Dies

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CRAFTING HIGH-STAKES SCENES

12. *Raiders of the Lost Ark*

Scene: The Opening of the Ark

How does the color help tell the story, or communicate goals? Great use of shading. Do you think this storyboard helped them light the scene?

Story board example • Raiders of the Lost Ark

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: BRINGING THE PAST TO LIFE VISUALLY

13. *Forrest Gump*

Scene: Meet President Johnson

Robert Zemeckis combined custom footage with old newsreel footage. Covering the scene in close-ups helped them shroud inconsistencies.

Here's what the storyboard would look like, frame-by-frame:

Storyboards by Chris Bonura • Click to view the entire Forest Gump storyboard

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: HISTORICAL DRAMA

14. *Gone with the Wind*

Scene: Fleeing Atlanta

Did the colors in the storyboard help with the lighting schemes later? Storyboard notes help us understand the action. Lots of depth in slide three.

Storyboards by William Cameron Menzies for Gone With the Wind

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: RHYTHM, PERFORMANCE, AND SPECTACLE

15. *Apocalypse Now*

Scene: Ride of the Valkyries

The focus seems to be on how to shoot the air cavalry. Notice the carnage behind Col. Kilgore. Do these helicopters look heroic? Evil? Neutral?

Storyboards by Alex Tavoularis • Apocalypse Now

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CRAFTING HIGH-STAKES SCENES

16. Ali

Scene: Muhammad Ali vs. Ernie Terrell

Directional storyboard arrows show where punches come from. It is important to replicate actual fights. A big wide establishing shot of the arena creates scope.

Here's what the storyboard looks like:

Storyboards by Tim Burgard • Click to view the All storyboard

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: PERIOD DRAMAS & EPIC HISTORICAL FILMS

17. *Spartacus*

Scene: Battle Plans

How many storyboard battle scenes have drawn inspiration from Spartacus? One slide is dedicated to arrows in mid-flight, showcasing dynamic motion. These storyboard samples are rich in color and detail.

Example of storyboard • Spartacus

Interesting composition and angle choice.

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: DESIGNING FEAR FRAME BY FRAME

18. *The Towering Inferno*

Scene: Elevator Rescue Scene

There are many high angles in this storyboard, adding scale and tension. In complex stunt and VFX sequences, storyboards are essential for maintaining consistency and guiding departments like cinematography and editing. Big action scenes require careful planning to ensure seamless visual continuity.

Story board example • The Towering Inferno

Here we have a scene with stunts, special effects, and a difficult location.

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CRAFTING HIGH-STAKES SCENES

19. Salt

Scene: Rooftop Scene

This storyboard depicts a scene where Salt hangs from a rope before letting go. The artist's use of composition and background imagery—such as cop cars and the rock garden—adds depth and helps communicate key visual elements. These details are crucial for other departments, ensuring consistency in set design, VFX, and cinematography.

Storyboard Example - Salt Storyboard - Tim Burgard - StudioBinder

Storyboard Example by Tim Burgard

There are references to a camera pan with the rope swing as well.

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: MISDIRECTION AND NARRATIVE TWISTS

20. *Interview with the Vampire*

Scene: Ending Scene

Spoiler: this storyboard shows the final scene where Lestat bites Mallory.

Storyboard Examples - Interview with the Vampire Storyboard - StudioBinder

Interview with the Vampire Storyboard Example

Notice how the pacing of the scene is referenced in the storyboard notes. The scene plays out a bit differently in the movie, which may have been done on purpose or maybe the shot didn't work out as planned.

RELATED POSTS

- Break It Down: How to Make a Storyboard →
- Unlock More: StudioBinder's Storyboard Creator →
- Level Up: The Best Storyboard Software to Use →

Musical Storyboard Examples

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: TIMING & VISUAL COMEDY

21. *Austin Powers 3*

Scene: Opening

When you're shooting a scene that incorporates stunts and a visual effect component, it's super important to storyboard camera movement down to a tee.

Click to view the full storyboard below:

Film storyboard template • Click to view the Austin Power 3 storyboard

Jay Roach had only eight hours to s[illegible] of the best opening sequences, and you can see that it did not stop him from nailing down that task.

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: RHYTHM, PERFORMANCE & CHOREOGRAPHY

22. *Moulin Rouge*

Scene: Diamonds Are a Girl's Best Friend

The use of directional arrows keeps us oriented. A POV shot of Sabine reaching out is one slide that jumps out to me. Close-ups to wide shots.

Film storyboard template • Moulin Rouge

Baz Luhrmann uses lots of angle changes in this scene, and you can see the complicated edit visualized during the storyboard process.

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: TIMING AND BLOCKING

23. *The Sound of Music*

Scene: Do-Re-Mi

Lots of symmetry in these shots. A ton of complicated choreography. Great depth in many of the slides due to creative blocking.

Film storyboard template • The Sound of Music

There is a fantasy element to how much ground they cover.

Horror Storyboard Examples

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: BUILDING FEAR WITH COMPOSITION & FRAMING

24. *Get Out*

Scene: Sunken Place Scene

This digital storyboard shows a scene where Chris falls into the sunken place after being hypnotized by Missy Armitage.

Storyboard Example - Get Out Storyboard 2 - Eric Yamamoto - StudioBinder

Get Out Sunken Place Storyboard Example by Eric Yamamoto

Here's a continuation of this storyboard:

Storyboard Example - Get Out Storyboard - Eric Yamamoto - StudioBinder

Get Out Sunken Place #2 Storyboard Example by Eric Yamamoto

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: MISDIRECTION AND SUSPENSE IN EVERY FRAME

25. *Psycho*

Scene: Trouble in the Shower

The knife shot is the same in the film. Look at the intended close-up of her mouth when she's stabbed. Sex, comfort, and murder collide.

Click to view the full storyboard below:

Click to view Psycho storyboard

A happy face in the first few slides [illegible] huge tonal shift in this scene.

Psycho • Trouble in the Shower

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: THE CINEMATIC TRICKS BEHIND FEAR & TENSION

26. *The Birds*

Scene: Playground Scene

This storyboard example shows the birds gathering on the school playground while the children are inside the school.

Storyboard Examples - The Birds Storyboard - StudioBinder

The Birds • Storyboard Example

This scene plays out differently in the actual film, but the overall purpose of the storyboard is still very much present.

Children Get Attacked By Birds

RELATED POSTS

- Learn More: How to Make a Storyboard Template →
- Shot List vs Storyboard — And Why You Need Both? →
- Storyboard Rules — The Do's and Don'ts of Storyboarding →

Fantasy Storyboard Examples

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CREATING OTHERWORLDLY CINEMATIC VISIONS

27. *Spider-Man 2*

Scene: Train Battle

This storyboard looks like a comic book...Spidey is losing, then winning. Lots of directional arrows.

Story board example • Spider-Man 2

We need at least three more Spider-Man reboots! I'd do another pithy storyboard pun but Spider-Man is never sarcastic....

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: THE CINEMATIC TRICKS BEHIND FEAR & TENSION

28. *Logan*

Scene: Decapitation Scene

This storyboard shows the scene where Logan decapitates Jackson. This is a detailed storyboard example by a very talented storyboard artist.

Storyboard Examples - Logan Storyboard - Mark Vena - StudioBinder

Logan Storyboard by Mark Vena

There were a lot of brutal scenes throughout *Logan*, and the storyboard artist's job was to capture the emotion in the sketch.

Logan • Trailer

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES HOW DIRECTORS MAP OUT HIGH-STAKES SEQUENCES

29. *Ant-Man*

Scene: Ant Rescue Scene

Notice how storyboard artist Steven Markowski uses lines around Scott Lang's face to signal surprise. Storyboards don't have to be static—small touches like this add emotional and physical dynamics, making these 2D sketches feel more alive and expressive.

Ant-Man Storyboard by Steven Markowski

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES HOW BLOCKBUSTERS ARE PLANNED

30. *Iron Man*

Scene: Pepper Catches Tony Scene

This storyboard from Iron Man captures the moment Pepper catches Tony trying to remove his suit after his first mission. Including bits of dialogue in the notes can help contextualize key moments like this, adding clarity to character interactions and ensuring the visual storytelling aligns with the script's tone and intent.

Storyboard Example - Ironman Storyboard - David Duncan - StudioBinder

Iron Man Storyboard Example by David Duncan

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CLOSE-UPS, PACING & PERFORMANCE

31. *Harry Potter and The Order of the Phoenix*

Scene: Battle at the Department of Mysteries

Directional arrows help keep us organized. High-angle shot when they enter the Department. Slide two illustrates confusion.

Storyboards by Jim Cornish for Harry Potter and the Order of the Phoenix

Notice how it's a point-of-view shot when Harry casts a spell.

Battle at the Department of Mysteries • Harry Potter and the Order of the Phoenix

MOVIE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: STORYBOARDING FOR MAXIMUM IMPACT

32. *Percy Jackson*

Scene: Medusa Scene

This storyboard depicts Percy Jackson confronting Medusa, designed specifically for an anamorphic aspect ratio. Storyboards should always be framed with the final aspect ratio in mind, ensuring compositions translate effectively to the screen.

Storyboard Example - Percy Jackson Storyboard - Tim Burgard - StudioBinder

Percy Jackson Storyboard by Tim Burgard

The storyboard example has sound effects added as well as detailed shot descriptions that help tell the story through visuals.

Percy Jackson • Medusa Scene

RELATED POSTS

- Learn More: What is a Digital Storyboard →
- Unlock Insights: Storyboard Composition Explained →
- FREE Download: Storyboard Templates →

TV Storyboard Examples

TELEVISION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: CONSTRUCTING NEW WORLDS ON PAPER

33. *Game of Thrones*

Scene: Daenerys Targaryen Give Birth Scene

This storyboard shows a scene where Daenerys gives birth to three dragons which works out perfectly for everyone in the last season.

Storyboard Examples - Game of Thornes Storyboard - StudioBinder

Daenerys Gives Birth Storyboard Example

TV STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: STORYBOARDING FOR TWISTS AND TURNS

34. *Buffy The Vampire Slayer*

Scene: Mouth of Hell

Parallel action occurs on the same storyboard. More depth with the wider shots. Storyboards are great for any effects-heavy TV show or film.

This *Buffy the Vampire Slayer* storyboard example showcases how parallel action can build suspense across different character arcs. This storyboard example also illustrates the importance of balancing depth and action within a single storyboard frame—something that works just as well for TV as it does for social media storytelling.

Storyboards by Charles Ratteray for Vampire Slayer

You can start to see why Whedon was called on to direct *The Avengers*.

TV STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: HOW TV DIRECTORS USE STORYBOARDS

35. *Westworld*

Scene: Reckoning

Similar to the storyboard example above, you can show parallel action on a single storyboard. Notice how important the arrows are in this storyboard and how they inform the order of the edits.

Storyboard Examples - Westworld - Dan Caplan - StudioBinder-min

Westworld Season 2 Storyboard Example by Dan Caplan

Here is the trailer from season 2 of *Westworld*:

Westworld • Season 2 Trailer

RELATED POSTS

- Learn More: How to Make a Storyboard →
- Comprehensive Study: How to Storyboard a Montage? →
- Pro Tips: How to Storyboard if You Can't Draw →

Animation Storyboard Examples

ANIMATION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: THE FOUNDATION OF ANIMATED MASTERPIECES

36. *Kung Fu Panda*

Scene: Training Scene

This animatic shows a scene where Po attempts Kung Fu training.

Kung Fu Panda Storyboard Example by Angelo Libutti

Because this is an animation storyboard the images you see in this example are the actual building blocks for the final image. Animation projects like this are excellent inspiration for storyboard creators who want to translate character emotions and actions into compelling visuals.

Training Scene

ANIMATION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: HOW ICONIC FILMS WERE FIRST VISUALIZED

37. *Up*

Scene: Opening Scene

This storyboard example from *Up* demonstrates the importance of layering emotional beats into visual storytelling. Each frame provides a vivid visual representation of the emotional highs and lows, guiding the audience through the story seamlessly. This shows the opening scene in *Up*, which is super uplifting and not painful at all.

Animators rely on iterative drafts to refine their storyboards, a process that can also benefit educators by explaining complex ideas step-by-step.

Storyboard Examples - Up Storyboard - StudioBinder

Up • Storyboard Example

Again, because this storyboard was made for an animated feature film you can see how closely the storyboard example is the final product.

Opening Scene from • Up

ANIMATION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: FIGHT SEQUENCES, CHASES & PHYSICAL COMEDY

38. *Tom and Jerry*

Scene: Orphan Episode

Here you can see some of the earliest animation storyboard examples from an episode of *Tom and Jerry*.

Storyboard Examples - Tom and Jerry Storyboard - StudioBinder

Tom and Jerry • Storyboard Example

ANIMATION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: HOW ARTISTS PLAN EVERY FRAME BEFORE ANIMATION BEGINS

39. *Summer Camp Island*

Scene: Witch Episode

This storyboard shows an important moment in the show where the youngsters realize their camp counselors are witches. How fun!

Storyboard Examples - Summer Camp Storyboard - StudioBinder

Summer Camp Island • Storyboard Example

Check out the scene below to see how the storyboard leads to the final scene, and how closely they resemble each other.

Summer Camp Island • Episode

ANIMATION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: FIGHT SEQUENCES AND CHASES

40. *Batman*

Scene: Series Intro

This storyboard shows the introduction sequence for the *Batman Animated Series*. Seeing these slides brings back sweet memories.

Click to view the Batman storyboard

There is no better clarification of how useful storyboards can be when you see one from an animated film or television show. Animators often understand visual literacy better than many film directors.

Storyboard Examples - Batman Storyboard - StudioBinder

Batman Animated • Storyboard Example

ANIMATION STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: WHY STORYBOARDING IS ESSENTIAL

41. *Adventure Time*

Scene: Tree Trunks Alien Scene

This storyboard example from the animated show *Adventure Time* shows how you can add dialogue and screen direction to your animated storyboards to make them as specific as needed.

Storyboard Examples - Adventure Time Storyboard - StudioBinder

Adventure Time • Storyboard Example

RELATED POSTS

- Learn More: How to Make an Animatic →
- Deep Dive: What is an Animation Storyboard? →
- Explore: The Best Animation Software to Use →

Video Game Storyboard Examples

VIDEO GAME STORYBOARD EXAMPLES FOR INTERACTIVE DESIGN: THE ROLE OF STORYBOARDS IN VIDEO GAME DESIGN

42. *Super Mario Odyssey*

Scene: Game Intro Scene

The *Super Mario Odyssey* storyboard example highlights how video game storyboards differ from films by focusing on player interaction and progression. Storyboarding examples like this require special attention to pacing and choice. Using storyboard software can help map out complex interactive elements for your game.

This particular example allows you to play the game either as Mario... or as Mario's hat, which is exactly as fun as it sounds.

Storyboard Examples - Super Mario Odyssey Storyboard - StudioBinder

Super Mario Odyssey Video Game • Storyboard Example

Storyboards can be used for film, television, animation, and video games because they are the perfect tool for communicating visual goals.

Super Mario Odyssey • Intro

VIDEO GAME STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: HOW CUTSCENES BRING GAMES TO LIFE

43. *Gears of War*

Scene: Mad World Trailer

This storyboard example shows the trailer for *Gears of War*. This trailer featured the song "Mad World", and helped create a successful launch for the series. The games are great, but no doubt the trailer helped a lot.

Storyboard Examples - Gears of War - Dwayne Turner - StudioBinder-min

Gears of War • Storyboard Example by Dwayne Turner

This *Gears of War* storyboard is a strong video storyboard example, illustrating how carefully planned visuals can elevate a game trailer into an iconic cinematic experience. The use of music and mood-driven pacing demonstrates the power of storyboarding in emotional storytelling.

Check out the trailer to see how the storyboard translated on screen:

Gears of War • "Mad World" Trailer

VIDEO GAME STORYBOARD EXAMPLES: MAPPING PLAYER EXPERIENCES VISUALLY

44. *Major League Baseball*

Scene: PS3 Move Trailer

This video storyboard example shows the trailer for *Major League Baseball* for the PlayStation 3. This storyboard was created to show how the PS move system could mentally transport players onto the field.

Storyboard Examples - MLB PS3 - Dwayne Turner - StudioBinder-min

Major League Baseball • Storyboard Example by Dwayne Turner

ABOUT THESE STORYBOARD EXAMPLES

Storyboards force creative filmmaking

Have you ever had a great idea for a shot or even an entire scene? Everything is visualized perfectly in your mind, but will it make it to the screen?

What you need is a storyboard. This is what professional directors and production companies use to communicate visual ideas with their teams.

In fact:

- Cavemen used storyboards.
- The Ancient Egyptians used storyboards.

Bottom line: Storyboards work.

While some of the reasons storyboards work so well may seem painfully obvious, there are more nuanced rationales that many novice (and professional) filmmakers tend to overlook.

You may not have a huge budget, so naturally, you think you're limited. That line of thinking can be harmful to your project because what you're doing is limiting your creativity, which in turn limits the effectiveness of your vision, which in turn limits your project.

Don't waste valuable energy thinking about limitations. Take that energy and create storyboard ideas for your scene (or look through websites where to find storyboard artists for hire). Make sure to spend some time sketching out your storyboard ideas, even if they're just samples. You'll often hear the suggestion to:

"Draw your storyboard ideas with stick figures if you're not an artist."

I strongly disagree.

Take your time to draw—even if it's an ugly storyboard. Why? Because drawing forces you to think critically about every detail:

- An ugly background.
- An ugly foreground.
- Ugly characters.
- Thoughtful shot compositions.

If you want to refine your skills, you can even explore Storyboard Classes Online to build a stronger foundation.

Suddenly, new storyboard ideas are popping into your head:

- Maybe a special easter egg is hidden in the background of a shot.
- Or perfect symmetry for a specific point in the story.
- Perhaps a match cut from one image to another.

These are all cinematic goals often born out of storyboarding. Directors like Tim Burton and Wes Anderson excel at using precise shot composition and unique production design.

They put imagery on the screen that doesn't exist anywhere else in the real world. Their teams built, scouted and pieced together a world that once existed only in their minds.

How did they communicate their visions? Their teams used storyboards to bring their ideas to life.

Learn as much as you can from these movie storyboard examples and see how you can bring your dream from your head to the big screen.

STORYBOARDING WITH STUDIOBINDER

Create the perfect storyboard

When you study professional storyboards like these, you quickly begin to understand how much effort goes into the planning stages of a film.

Successful projects use the pre-production phase to the fullest. When you create a tangible plan for your production, you will limit possible miscommunications, and maximize creative output from your team.

If you use storyboarding software like StudioBinder, you can show how each scene will play out, and keep your entire plan organized in a single digitally accessible place.

Create a Storyboard with StudioBinder • Subscribe on YouTube

Your entire production team can collaborate from anywhere at any time. Instead of wasting hours playing phone tag with assistants or scheduling late-night conference calls because of time zone differences.

Storyboarding is the key to turning ideas into compelling visuals, whether you're crafting a film, animation, or marketing campaign. Why not streamline the process with a powerful, easy-to-use tool?

Try StudioBinder's Online Storyboard Creator for free and start mapping out your next masterpiece. With intuitive features and a seamless workflow, you can visualize your shots, organize your scenes, and collaborate effortlessly. Don't just imagine it—storyboard it today!

UP NEXT:

Make a storyboard in StudioBinder

Ready to create your storyboard? Use StudioBinder to collaborate with your team in real-time, whether you're sketching out storyboard examples for a feature film, marketing campaign, or educational video.

A storyboard is more than just a tool; it's a visual roadmap that keeps your creative team aligned and on track.

Download our free storyboard checklist to make sure you're covering every detail. Whether you need tools or just inspiration for storyboard concepts, these resources will help you get started and refine your ideas.

You can use one of our 60+ FREE storyboard templates or build and share your storyboards through the cloud with StudioBinder's storyboarding and pre-production software.

Build Your Storyboards with These Tools →

Get Started for Free

Tags: Adventure Time, Ali, Alien, Ant-Man, Apocalypse Now, Austin Powers, Batman: The Animated Series, Baz Luhrmann, Buffy the Vampire Slayer, Coen Brothers, Edge of Tomorrow, Forrest Gump, Game of Thrones, George Lucas, Get Out, Gladiator, Gone with the Wind, Harry Potter, Inception, Indiana Jones, Interview with the Vampire, Iron Man, Jay Roach, Jurassic Park, Kung Fu Panda, Logan, Michael Bay, Moulin Rouge!, No Country for Old Men, Pacific Rim, Percy Jackson, Psycho, Ridley Scott, Robert Zemeckis, Salt, Spartacus, Spider-Man, Star Wars, Storyboarding, Summer Camp Island, The Avengers, The Birds, The Sound of Music, The Towering Inferno, There Will Be Blood, Tom and Jerry, Tomorrow Never Dies, Transformers, Up, West Side Story, Westworld

SC Lannom

SC Lannom is a screenwriter and director living in Los Angeles. He works as a writer, director, and content producer here at StudioBinder.

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